

Day 5 — Pairs Race

Module: Multiply-Near-Ten (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children speed up the finger trick to under 5 seconds per problem.

Materials

- A “Race Sheet” — 16 problems (all combinations 6×6 through 9×9) on a single page.
- Stopwatch.

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Twins chant + 5 finger-trick chorus answers.

Race round 1 (8 min)

- Pass out the Race Sheet (face-down).
- On “Go,” flip and solve all 16 problems using the finger trick. As fast as possible.
- After 3 minutes, “Stop.” Note how far each child got and how many were correct.
- Self-correct against the answer key.

Race Sheet:

$6 \times 6 = \underline{\quad}$	$7 \times 6 = \underline{\quad}$	$8 \times 6 = \underline{\quad}$	$9 \times 6 = \underline{\quad}$
$6 \times 7 = \underline{\quad}$	$7 \times 7 = \underline{\quad}$	$8 \times 7 = \underline{\quad}$	$9 \times 7 = \underline{\quad}$
$6 \times 8 = \underline{\quad}$	$7 \times 8 = \underline{\quad}$	$8 \times 8 = \underline{\quad}$	$9 \times 8 = \underline{\quad}$
$6 \times 9 = \underline{\quad}$	$7 \times 9 = \underline{\quad}$	$8 \times 9 = \underline{\quad}$	$9 \times 9 = \underline{\quad}$

Answer key:

36	42	48	54
42	49	56	63
48	56	64	72
54	63	72	81

Race round 2 (7 min)

- Same sheet, fresh strip. Solve as many as possible in 2 minutes.
- Beat your round-1 count.

Pair quick-fire (8 min)

- Pair up.
- Partner A reads a problem from the sheet. Partner B answers within 5 seconds (using fingers).

- Swap. Cover 10 problems each.

Wrap-up (4 min)

- Hands up: who got all 16 right? Who beat their round-1 score?
- Cheering. Final chant.

Homework

- Practice 6×6 through 9×9 at home. 5 minutes a day. Time yourself.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try problems with at least one factor being 5 (e.g. 5×8 , 5×9). The trick still works! And: do all 16 in 60 seconds.
- **Tier down:** 8 problems instead of 16. Half the sheet is fine.

Teacher's quick notes

- Don't make this competitive between children. "*Race yourself, not your neighbour.*"
- A child who got 4/16 should celebrate — that's progress from yesterday's 0/16.
- Some children will revert to memorised times-table answers. That's fine, but ask them to confirm with the finger trick.